

USING RESOURCES – POTABLE WATER

KEY VOCABULARY

Potable water: water that is safe to drink (low in microbes/salts).

Sterilisation: killing microbes using chlorine, ozone or UV.

Desalination: removing salt from sea water.

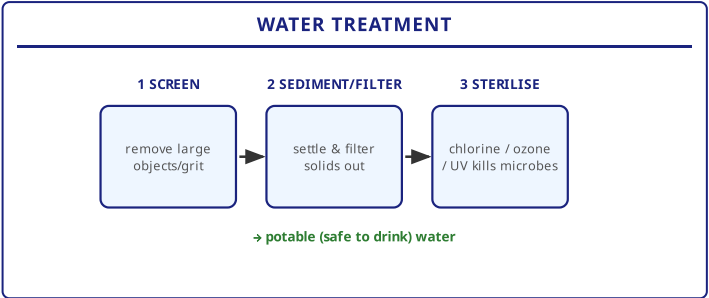
Distillation: boiling and condensing to purify water.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

~~—Potable water is pure water.~~
✓ It is safe to drink but may contain dissolved salts.

~~—Filtration removes microbes.~~
✓ Sterilisation is needed to kill microbes.

~~—Desalination is cheap.~~
✓ It needs lots of energy, so it is expensive.



1 DEFINE

State what is meant by **potable water**. [1 mark]

2 TREATMENT STEPS

Describe the main steps used to treat fresh water to make it potable. [3 marks]

3 STERILISATION

Name two methods used to **sterilise** water. [2 marks]

4 DESALINATION

Explain why desalination is expensive. [2 marks]

5 FILL THE GAPS

Complete the sentence using the word bank. [2 marks]

Water is ____ to remove solids and ____ to kill microbes.

sterilised filtered salt microbes

6 WHY NOT PURE

Explain why potable water is not the same as pure water. [1 mark]